



Medici ceramic
15th century • ITALY

This tin-glazed majolica plate, emblazoned with the Medici coat of arms, suggests the wealth and prestige of the Medici dynasty in Florence.

red ball signifies a medicine pill

pose of the goddess Venus is based on a Roman statue



straight lines represent headings of mariner's compass

Mediterranean sea

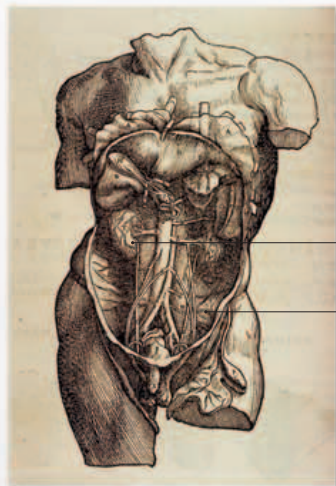
Mappa Mundi
1502 • SPAIN

Venice's wealth derived from its dominance of world trade routes. This map shows the Mediterranean and its adjacent seas, which Venetian ships regularly visited to distribute goods that were carried to the west by overland trade routes.



The Birth of Venus
c. 1486 • ITALY

This masterly painting of the early Renaissance by Botticelli (c. 1445–1510) refers directly to the Renaissance desire to appropriate and update ancient Roman ideals of beauty.



kidney

abdominal cavity with intestines removed to reveal underlying organs

fur-trimmed coat denotes wealth and prestige

Organs in the abdominal cavity
c. 1453 • ITALY

From *De humani corporis fabrica* by Andreas Vesalius (1514–64), this anatomical diagram typifies the Renaissance determination to expand scientific knowledge.



celestial globe symbolizes navigational skills

torquetum, an astronomical instrument, symbolizes scientific learning

Asian carpet symbolizes exploration

structure based on a bat's wing

distorted skull symbolizes death; when viewed from the side, the skull is undistorted

lute with broken string suggests religious discord

hand-crank mechanism

The Ambassadors
1533 • GERMANY

A highly detailed painting with complex symbolism, this portrait of two young French diplomats by Hans Holbein the Younger (c. 1497–1543) includes much evidence of their lives and accomplishments as cultured men of the Renaissance.

Hand-powered wing
c. 1490 • ITALY

Leonardo da Vinci produced several proposals for human-powered flying machines, including this sketch for a hand-cranked wing from his 12-volume *Codex Atlanticus*.

